Tree Hits Your Roof in Metro Atlanta? What to Do Next

A tree strike means a falling trunk or limb has breached your roof system - cracking decking, snapping rafters, or puncturing shingles and flashing in a single impact. That exact scenario played out when a massive tree crushed a Stone Mountain home during an active High Wind Warning that explicitly listed Cobb, Gwinnett, DeKalb, and dozens of other Metro Atlanta counties (Source: FOX 5 Atlanta, October 2026). When a tree hits your roof, the first hours shape both your safety and your insurance claim.

The short answer: If a tree hits your roof, get everyone away from the damaged area, call 911 for any downed power lines, then document the damage with photos before arranging a professional roof inspection. **Who this affects:** Homeowners across Cobb, DeKalb, Gwinnett, Fulton, and Cherokee counties - the areas named in the recent High Wind Warning - especially homes with mature tree canopy near the roofline. **What to do:** Photograph everything, cover exposed areas safely from the ground, and schedule a documented inspection before your adjuster visits. **Timeline:** Begin documentation as soon as safely possible and before the next storm system moves through.

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors documents tree-strike and storm damage before the insurance adjuster arrives, building a photo-documented report that strengthens your claim from the first day.

What Should You Do in the First Hours After a Tree Hits Your Roof?

Move people and pets away from the damaged section first, then treat every nearby wire as live. Georgia Power officials warned during Hurricane Isaias not to touch downed or low-hanging wires - including telephone or TV lines resting on a power line - and to call 911 or Georgia Power if you see a fallen line, since downed wires can hide in debris and wreckage (Source: AJC, October 2026). Structural impacts can compromise ceilings and attic framing, so stay out of rooms directly beneath the strike. Once the area is safe, photograph the tree, the roof breach, and any interior water intrusion before anyone moves debris. Those first images become the backbone of your insurance claim.

How Do High Winds Turn a Tree Into a Roof Hazard in Metro Atlanta?

High winds turn trees into roof hazards when gusts exceed what saturated soil and aging limbs can hold, driving trunks and branches onto the roof deck. The High Wind Warning tied to the Stone Mountain tree collapse covered Cobb, DeKalb, Gwinnett, North Fulton, Cherokee, and many surrounding counties until Sunday morning (Source: FOX 5 Atlanta, October 2026). During Hurricane Isaias, a large tree fell on North Fulton Drive in Buckhead, and state officials reported downed trees and power outages as the primary statewide impacts (Source: AJC, October 2026). With so many Metro Atlanta counties under a single wind warning, wind-driven tree strikes become a region-wide roof risk in the same storm. After any high-wind event, walk your property line and note leaning trees or hanging limbs before scheduling a professional roof inspection.

Which Metro Atlanta Neighborhoods Face the Highest Tree-Strike Roof Risk?

Neighborhoods where the active warnings and documented strikes landed carry the clearest, current risk. Stone Mountain is where the FOX 5-documented collapse occurred, with a full-size tree crushing a home during the warning window - a direct example of what sustained wind can do to a roof in DeKalb County. Buckhead saw a large tree fall on North Fulton Drive during Hurricane Isaias, showing that even established Fulton corridors are exposed when soil saturates and wind builds. Beyond those two confirmed impacts, the High Wind Warning named Cobb, Gwinnett, Cherokee, and North Fulton among dozens of counties, so homeowners in Marietta, Lawrenceville, Suwanee, Roswell, and Smyrna shared the same wind threat even where no single strike made the news. The practical lesson is simple: if your county appeared in the warning and you have trees near the roofline, treat your roof as potentially affected and get it looked at.

As a licensed Metro Atlanta roofing contractor, Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors handles storm damage restoration assessments across Cobb, DeKalb, Fulton, Gwinnett, and Cherokee counties - the same areas named in the recent High Wind Warning.

When Does a Tree Strike Mean Roof Repair Versus Full Roof Replacement?

A tree strike calls for repair when damage stays localized to shingles and a small section of decking, and full roof replacement when the impact compromises rafters, the deck across multiple planes, or the structural ridge. A single limb puncture over one room often means targeted storm damage roof repair. A full trunk collapse - like the Stone Mountain home crushed during the warning (Source: FOX 5 Atlanta, October 2026) - typically forces replacement because the load fractures framing and flashing beyond spot fixes. Hidden damage matters too: a tree that lands and rolls can tear flashing and loosen fasteners well beyond the visible hole. A documented inspection determines whether your insurer should fund repair or a complete roof system.

Location & Scenario	Common Tree-Strike Damage	Repair or Replace	Homeowner Action
Stone Mountain (documented collapse, DeKalb)	Trunk collapse fracturing rafters	Full roof replacement	Document structural breach; secure attic access
Buckhead (tree down on North Fulton Dr, Fulton)	Large limb through decking	Repair if single-plane, replace if widespread	Photograph before debris removal
Marietta / East Cobb (county under warning)	Limb impact, flashing damage	Repair with flashing replacement	Inspect flashing and valleys closely

Lawrenceville / Suwanee (Gwinnett under warning)	Branch impact near roof edge	Repair, verify gutter and fascia	Inspect fascia and soffit; clear gutters
Roswell / Smyrna (county under warning)	Interior water intrusion from breach	Depends on decking scope	Check interior ceilings for water stains

How Does Roof Condition Affect Your Tree-Strike Insurance Claim?

Roof condition directly affects whether an insurer pays your full claim, because adjusters separate storm impact from pre-existing wear. If a tree tears through shingles that were already brittle, or lands on failed flashing, an adjuster may attribute part of the damage to deferred maintenance rather than the storm. Worn flashing at valleys and penetrations is a frequent dispute point - it leaks after impact, but insurers question whether the leak predated the tree. A current, photo-documented roof inspection establishes the roof's condition before the strike and ties the new damage to the dated weather event. During Isaias, Georgia reported 120,368 customers without power statewide shortly before noon Saturday alongside widespread downed trees (Source: AJC, October 2026), giving homeowners a clear, dated event to anchor a claim. Peachtree's insurance claims assistance pairs that inspection report with the storm timeline so your documentation holds up.

What Does a Tree-Strike Roof Claim Cost and How Long Does It Take?

A tree-strike roof claim's out-of-pocket cost comes down to your deductible, while the repair timeline depends on structural scope and material lead times. Localized storm damage roof repair moves faster than a full replacement, which requires reframing, decking, flashing, and shingles across the affected planes. Emergency roof repair - a tarp or temporary cover - should happen first to stop water intrusion, followed by the permanent fix once the adjuster signs off. For the gap between your deductible and the project scope, ask your contractor about available financing options so repairs are not delayed by budget timing. Document every expense from the first tarp forward, because reasonable mitigation costs are typically reimbursable under your claim.

FAQ

Should I file an insurance claim before or after I get my roof inspected?

Get your roof inspected first, then file - a documented inspection gives you facts instead of guesses. An inspection report with dated photos lets you describe the damage accurately and attach evidence from the start. Filing blind risks understating the scope, which can shortchange your payout. For a tree strike tied to a named event like the October 2026 wind warning across Cobb and DeKalb, pairing the inspection with the storm date strengthens the file. A professional roof inspection also catches hidden flashing and decking damage an untrained eye misses.

What should I photograph after a tree falls on my roof in Metro Atlanta?

Photograph the fallen tree, the roof breach, torn flashing, and any interior water stains before anyone touches the debris. Wide shots establish the whole scene; close-ups show punctures, cracked decking, and lifted shingles. Include the tree's base if wind or saturated ground caused the fall, since that supports a storm attribution. Capture ceilings, attic framing, and wet insulation inside the home. Time-stamped images taken close to the event date - like the Buckhead tree that fell on North Fulton Drive during Isaias - carry the most weight with adjusters.

Does homeowners insurance in Georgia cover a tree hitting my roof?

Most Georgia homeowners policies cover roof damage from a tree falling due to wind or storm, though coverage specifics vary by policy. The key is tying the damage to a sudden, dated event rather than gradual wear. An emergency declaration was approved for Georgia during Isaias, underscoring the recognized storm impact across the state. Your deductible applies, and the insurer may scrutinize the roof's pre-strike condition. A documented inspection helps separate storm damage from any pre-existing issues.

How fast should I cover a hole in my roof after a tree strike?

Cover an exposed hole as soon as it is safe to do so from the ground - water intrusion worsens damage every hour it stays open. Temporary tarping is mitigation your policy generally expects, and failing to act can reduce your payout if interior damage spreads. Never climb onto a compromised roof, especially with downed wires nearby; Georgia Power warned that fallen lines can hide in storm debris. Hire emergency roof repair if the breach is large or structural. Keep receipts for every mitigation step.

Who removes the tree versus who fixes the roof after a collapse?

Tree removal and roof repair are usually two separate services, and your claim can cover both when a storm causes the damage. A tree service or crane crew extracts the trunk safely, particularly after a full collapse like the Stone Mountain home crushed during the wind warning. A licensed roofing contractor then assesses structural and decking damage and completes the permanent repair or roof replacement. Coordinating the two matters so the roofer can inspect the deck immediately after the tree is clear. Document the roof the moment the tree is removed, before any temporary cover goes on.

Will an old roof get my tree-damage claim denied in Atlanta?

An old roof alone rarely triggers an outright denial, but worn condition can lead an adjuster to attribute part of the damage to wear rather than the tree. This is common with aged flashing and brittle shingles that leak after impact. A pre-loss or post-event inspection report helps prove the tree - not age - caused the breach. If your roof was near the end of its service life, the insurer may apply depreciation to that portion. Replacing a failing roof after a covered strike resets that exposure for future storms.

What flashing and ventilation damage should I check after a tree impact?

Check valley flashing, chimney and vent penetrations, and ridge vents - these are where tree impacts commonly tear the waterproof layer. Damaged flashing leaks even when shingles look intact, and insurers often dispute whether that leak is storm-related or old. Crushed ridge vents compromise attic airflow, which affects moisture and shingle life. A limb that lands and slides can bend flashing at the valleys well away from the visible breach. Flag any bent, lifted, or missing

metal in your inspection so it is included in the claim scope.

Can I choose my own roofing contractor for storm repairs in Georgia?

Yes - in Georgia you choose your own roofing contractor for storm repairs, regardless of insurer suggestions. Selecting a licensed and insured roofing contractor with manufacturer-backed workmanship protects your warranty. Verify the contractor documents damage thoroughly and works directly with your adjuster. Ask how they handle the claim timeline and material lead times before signing. This matters across Gwinnett and Cherokee suburbs where post-storm demand draws out-of-town crews.

Contact Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors for a free inspection.

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